Paid media judged on customers, not clicks.



Six case studies across in-house, agency and advisory work. Each one was judged on what the business needed: qualified applications, enrolments, funded loans and customers who came back.

Andrew Fonseka, MBA · Paid Media & Digital Marketing · Greater Vancouver, BC

7-figure
annual paid media program co-managed at Aegon

50
U.S. and Canadian business units I run

3 years
hands-on across agency, in-house and advisory work

Inside: Aegon · Private university · Pan Asia Bank · Petmart.lk · DIMO Academy

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CASE 01 · AEGON · IN-HOUSE · FINANCIAL SERVICES · H1 2026

Bid on pipeline, not form fills.

THE PROBLEM

Smart Bidding and Meta optimized for form submissions, which said nothing about who became a qualified applicant. Duplicate conversion events blurred which campaigns actually worked.

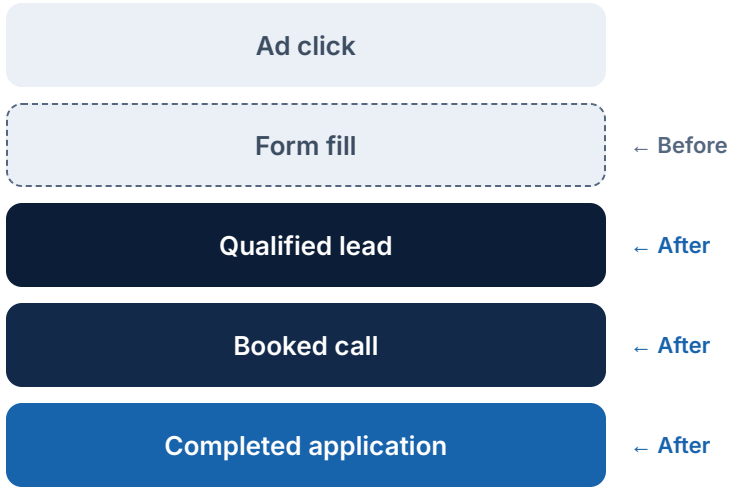
THE DECISION

Send **HubSpot stages back to the ad platforms** as offline conversions, then rebuild targeting, lead forms and landing pages around those stages.

MY ROLE

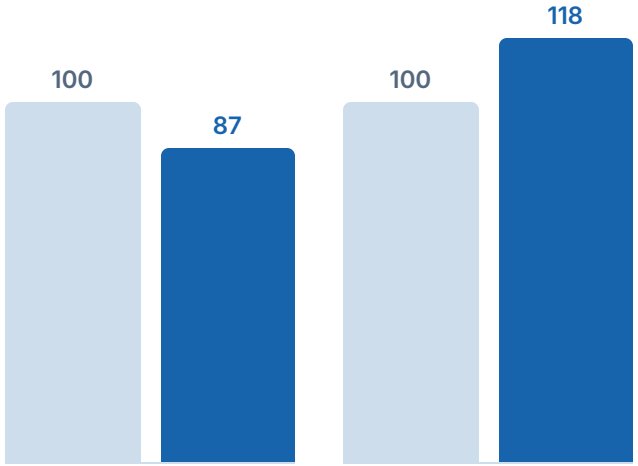
Launch and manage 20+ financial-product campaigns across 50 U.S. and Canadian business units on Google Ads, Meta and LinkedIn.

WHERE BIDDING LEARNS FROM



The optimization point moved three stages down the funnel, from a form to CRM-qualified outcomes.

RESULTS AT FLAT MEDIA SPEND (INDEX, BEFORE = 100)



−13%

cost per lead

+18%

completed applications

Before

After · H1 2026

Media spend: unchanged

Source: Google Ads, Meta and HubSpot, H1 2026. Indexed relative changes; absolute budgets and results are confidential. A before-and-after comparison, not a controlled lift test.

CASE 02 · AEGON · EXECUTION AND MEASUREMENT · 2025 – NOW

Trust the data. Then automate the routine.

HOW A CAMPAIGN GOES LIVE ACROSS 50 BUSINESS UNITS

01
Build
Structure, copy and settings assembled from a master sheet.

Apps Script builder

→

02
QA
Naming, UTMs and tracking checked before anything ships.

Google Ads Scripts

→

03
Compliance
Quebec and U.S. state-level rules for financial products.

Every campaign

→

04
Launch
Final approval from the Director, then live.

Google Ads · Meta · LinkedIn

→

05
Pace
Spend tracked against budget so waste shows early.

Pacing dashboards

→

06
Report
Weekly to senior management, biweekly to the CMO.

CRM outcomes, not clicks

META EVENT MATCH QUALITY

6.5 → 8.0



GA4, server-side GTM, Enhanced Conversions and Meta CAPI with hashed customer data.

COMPLIANCE REVIEW TIME

–60%



About 12 working days a year back, from the builder and automated checks.

TEAM ADOPTION

45

marketers now launch campaigns through the builder, so naming, UTMs and QA are the same everywhere.

WASTED SPEND

5-figure

monthly wasted spend eliminated once pacing dashboards and de-duplicated conversions showed where it went.

Working days saved is an estimate against the manual baseline. Absolute budgets and results are confidential.

CASE 03 · AEGON · LINKEDIN ACCOUNT-BASED PROGRAM · HIGH-NET-WORTH INVESTORS · 2026

Reach the right investors. Fund the regions that respond.

THE INVESTOR JOURNEY THE PROGRAM WAS BUILT AROUND

Prioritize	Reach	Enquire	Meet	Prepare	Fund
Custom audiences from job titles, seniority, company attributes and account lists.	Matched Audiences, Thought Leader Ads and carousel creative.	Enquiries flow into HubSpot and are qualified there.	Qualified investors book time with an advisor.	Advisors prepare the investment account.	Success is measured on funded accounts, not clicks.

THE REGIONAL FEEDBACK LOOP

1 · LinkedIn campaigns
Run by region across U.S. and Canada

→

2 · Qualified enquiries
HubSpot synced with Campaign Manager

↓

3 · Regional analysis
Compare qualified enquiries by region

←

4 · Audience and budget
Shift spend to regions that convert

↑

repeats every cycle

WHAT THE LOOP CAUGHT

One U.S. region produced fewer qualified enquiries, so budget moved toward the regions that did.

Budget follows qualified enquiries in the CRM, not reach or click-through rate. That keeps a high-value audience program honest when each lead is worth far more than a click.

Process view only. Results, targets, budget and performance metrics for this program are confidential.

CASE 04 · PRIVATE UNIVERSITY · SAUDI ARABIA · ADVISORY VIA A PARTNER AGENCY · MAY – AUG 2026

Optimize for enrolments, not form fills.

THE PROBLEM

Two colleges needed students. The broad campaign produced enquiries but only **17 enrolments** for them.

THE DECISION

Give the priority colleges a **dedicated Meta campaign** with its own budget and a higher-intent lead form, and judge every campaign on fee-paid enrolments in the CRM.

MY ROLE

Advised on Meta lead-generation strategy and helped launch the campaigns, set budget allocation and build CRM-matched reporting.

FROM LEAD TO FEE-PAID ENROLMENT

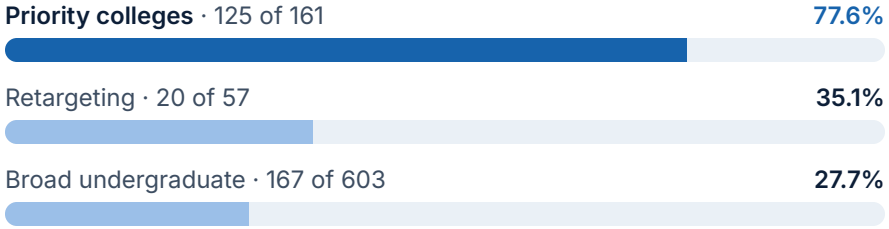


~US$20
per enrolment

38%
lead to enrolment

~US$6.2K
total media spend

LEAD TO ENROLMENT, BY CAMPAIGN



125 vs 17

enrolments for the two priority colleges from the dedicated campaign, against the broad one

THE TRADE-OFF

The priority campaign cost more per enrolment (US$28 vs US$13 on the broad one) but filled the colleges that needed students, which the blended average had hidden.

Source: Meta Ads Manager and the admissions CRM, 1 May – 31 Aug 2026; enrolments matched on name, phone and student ID and de-duplicated. Spend converted from SAR. Not a controlled test: targeting differed between campaigns.

CASE 05 · KITES GLOBAL · AGENCY · SRI LANKA · 2023

Loans that get funded. Customers who come back.

Pan Asia Bank

GOLD LOANS · META + GOOGLE ADS

259

funded gold loans

~US$97

media cost per funded loan

US$25K BUDGET, SPLIT BY LEAD QUALITY



US$25,000 ÷ 259 loans = US$96.53 per funded loan

My role: account lead. Designed and presented the Meta video strategy, set the 60/40 split and judged it weekly on funded loans, not form fills.

Petmart.lk

PET ECOMMERCE · SHOPPING + PMAX

4:1

first-order ROAS: about $4 of first-order sales per $1 of ad spend

+40%

paid-attributed sales, quarter over quarter

QUARTER OVER QUARTER (INDEX, BEFORE = 100)



My role: built the Merchant Center feed and split Shopping and Performance Max by new vs returning customers.

Client-reported. Pan Asia Bank: US$500K in loan principal, which is not revenue, so no ROAS is claimed. Petmart.lk: Apr – Jun 2023; first-order ROAS excludes lifetime value; not an incrementality test.

CASE 06 · DIMO ACADEMY FOR TECHNICAL STUDIES · TRADES EDUCATION · ADVISORY · 2026

More qualified leads. Same budget.

THE PROBLEM

The academy needed more enrolment-ready prospects without spending more. Raw form fills hid where the funnel was leaking.

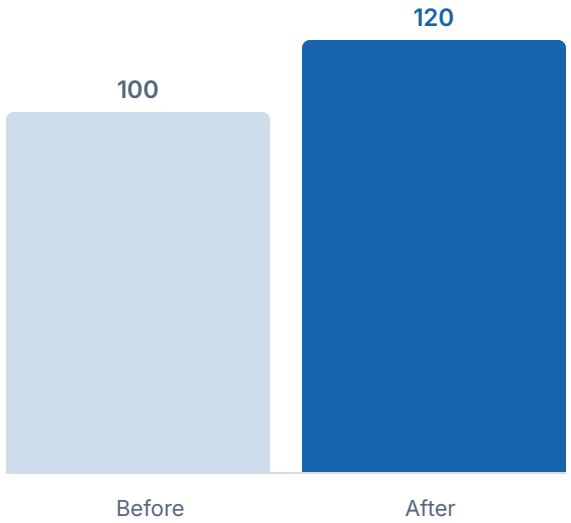
THE DECISION

Judge campaigns on **CRM-qualified leads**, rebuild Google Ads and Meta around them, and add **Microsoft Advertising** as a new source of intent.

MY ROLE

Advised on acquisition strategy and helped launch the rebuild, set budget allocation and report on CRM outcomes.

CRM-QUALIFIED LEADS (INDEX)



+20%

qualified leads at an unchanged ~US$900 monthly budget

WHERE LEADS CAME FROM IN THE SECOND QUARTER



A channel the academy wasn't using delivered **about 85 of 212 leads** once it was added.

WHAT CHANGED

01
Rebuild
Google Ads and Meta restructured around qualified leads.

02
Add intent
Microsoft Advertising launched as a new source.

03
Report
Budget and results reviewed on CRM outcomes.

Client-reported before-and-after comparison, not a controlled test. Channel share and the qualified-lead increase measure different things and are not combined.

HOW I WORK

Signal first. Budget follows evidence.

01

Audit the signal

Tracking, CRM fields, creative and search terms. Start with data you can trust.

02

Define the outcome

Agree the business goal, then build the channel mix and a focused test plan.

03

Test, learn, reallocate

Audiences, offers and creative, with the evidence deciding the next move.

04

Report what matters

Cost per customer, pipeline quality and a clear recommendation for what's next.

PAID MEDIA

Google Ads (Search, Shopping, Performance Max, Demand Gen) · Microsoft Advertising · Meta · LinkedIn · TikTok · DV360 · CM360

MEASUREMENT

GA4 · server-side GTM · Meta CAPI · Enhanced Conversions · offline conversions · Looker Studio · Supermetrics

CRM AND AUTOMATION

HubSpot · Dynamics 365 · Merchant Center · Shopify · Apps Script · Google Ads Scripts · Zapier

Let's talk paid media.

Greater Vancouver, BC · Authorized to work in Canada · References available on request

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